

SCAFFOLD

SUPPORTS TERTIARY HOW

FOR WHY-WHAT · WHAT-WHY

The Last 10% Protocol

A defined closing ritual for any deliverable. **The hardest part of finishing becomes a checklist, not a judgment call,** run in one pass before anything ships.

THE DRAIN

For WHY-WHAT and WHAT-WHY profiles the finish line moves: the interesting problem is solved, energy has already shifted to the next thing, and the closing details, quality passes, edge cases, handoffs, feel like the work is over. That last ten percent is where reputations quietly leak.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The protocol turns closing into a fixed sequence of five passes, run in order, every time. Nothing relies on noticing what needs finishing; the ritual asks the same questions of every deliverable. It takes thirty focused minutes and converts almost-done work into actually-done work.

The five closing passes

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|---|--------------|---|
| 1 | Quality pass | Read or run the whole thing once, end to end, as the recipient will. |
| 2 | Edge cases | What breaks at the boundaries, the first use, the odd input, the handoff? |
| 3 | Handoffs | Who receives this, and do they have everything they need to act on it? |
| 4 | Loose ends | Open comments, placeholder text, unsent notifications, stale links. |
| 5 | Sign-off | Named person confirms done against the definition of done. |

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 **Schedule the pass as its own block.** Thirty minutes, separate from the making. Closing is a different mode of work.
- 2 **Run the passes in order.** The sequence matters; quality before edge cases, edge cases before handoffs.
- 3 **Use the checklist physically.** Print it or keep it open. The point is to remove judgment from the process.
- 4 **Log anything you skip.** A skipped pass is a decision. Write it down so it is a choice, not a leak.

WHAT IT WON'T DO

It will not make finishing feel satisfying the way starting does, and it cannot replace deep review on complex technical work. It guarantees the floor: nothing ships without the same five questions being asked of it.

IN THE KIT

Closing pass checklist

Printable desk card

Skip log

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 2 Pre-Flight Checklist Library · **Tool 7** Definition-of-Done Cards ·
Tool 4 The Detail Debt Log